

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times



THE PHILIPPINES Bus and ride-share drivers have been marching in Quezon City, and quietly protesting by not going to work.



GUATEMALA Cars were set ablaze in Villa Nueva. Some people have demanded more than stopgap measures such as price caps.



SYRIA People blocked a highway and burned tires in Maarat al-Numan on Sunday. Several cities have seen similar protests.



PAKISTAN Jamaat-e-Islami party supporters blocked a highway last month in Lahore to protest an increased petroleum tax.

New Poll Finds Midterm Edge For Democrats

*Economy and President
Drag Down G.O.P.*

This article is by *Shane Goldmacher, Ruth Igielnik and Sophia June.*

With fewer than 50 days until the midterms, Democrats have developed a clear advantage over Republicans as the president has lost the public’s trust on the economy, according to a new national poll from The New York Times and Siena University.

President Trump’s lingering unpopularity and intense frustration over his management of cost-of-living issues, in particular, have deepened Republican vulnerabilities as Democrats push to win control of the House and Senate.

Likely voters favored Democratic candidates over Republicans by close to 9 percentage points in their congressional district — a metric that is closely watched by both parties as a leading indicator of political momentum.

Mr. Trump’s approval rating continued to languish at 38 percent among likely voters, essentially unchanged from the lows it sank to after he went to war with Iran. A majority of voters disapproved of Mr. Trump’s handling of every major issue included in the poll: the economy, immigration, tariffs, the war and, especially, the cost of living.

And voters said they trusted Democrats more than Republicans on not just health care and foreign wars but also on the two issues that powered Mr. Trump’s 2024 victory: immigration and the economy.

The political conditions found by the poll suggest the makings of a potential Democratic wave in November. But that outcome is far from assured. Thanks in part to gerrymandering, relatively few House seats are truly competitive, and in the run-up to the midterms, Republicans drew new House maps in several states favorable to their candidates. And even a nearly 9-point advantage would not guarantee flipping some of the Senate seats Democrats are counting on in 2026 — Texas, Ohio, Alaska, Iowa — which Mr. Trump won by double digits in 2024.

Still, independent voters have especially soured on Mr. Trump. Just 10 percent of them said the economy was better today than a year ago and only 27 percent approve of Mr. Trump’s job performance overall. And in the fight for Congress, 57 percent of independent voters said they planned to vote for a Democrat compared with only 34 percent for a Republican.

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STATES PRESS ON WITH MAIL VOTING ON COURT’S ORDER

JUSTICES BLOCK TRUMP

*Election Officials Work to
Restore Trust With
Confused Voters*

This article is by *Nick Corasaniti, Anna Griffin and Richard Fausset.*

Now that the Supreme Court has blocked President Trump’s executive order restricting mail voting ahead of the midterms, election officials across the country are shelving their contingency plans and preparing for a new effort: restoring trust in mail voting.

Mr. Trump’s repeated false attacks on voting by mail, which he continued on Tuesday, and the monthslong legal back and forth over whether he could restrict the practice through the Postal Service, have left many voters baffled.

On Monday, the court stopped the administration from carrying out a plan to have the U.S. Postal Service screen mail ballots before they were delivered to voters. The



Workers preparing absentee ballots in Raleigh, N.C.

administration argued that the procedure would prevent ineligible people from voting, but many state election officials said the plan was unreliable and would create chaos so close to the midterm elections.

With the legal question now settled, election officials at the state and local levels will now shift their focus to communicating to voters that they can trust that they can securely continue to vote by mail without federal restrictions.

“We’ve actually been working all weekend to figure out the different scenarios for the outcomes of the decision,” said Francisco Aguilar, a Democrat who is Nevada’s secretary of state. “And one of them was, Hey, if we are in a position where we get a favorable ruling from the courts, what are we going to do to educate voters and to build that confidence that their ballot is going to get counted?”

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Energy Prices Incite Protests Around World

By **DAMIEN CAVE**

HO CHI MINH CITY, Vietnam — The world is furious — again — over rising energy prices caused by the American-Israeli war against Iran.

Since the latest surge pushed oil above \$100 a barrel, protesters have burned tires and cars in Guatemala and Syria to express their rage.

Portugal’s roads have featured cars crawling in protest with honking horns after diesel reached a record high of more than \$9 a gallon.

And especially in the developing countries of Asia, which are heavily reliant on Middle Eastern energy and deep in debt from earlier efforts to offset the war’s impacts, transport systems and governments are facing another round of enormous strain.

Fuel shortages and long lines at the pump are slowing economies along with strikes by taxi drivers and laborers who see no point in working when earnings barely cover energy costs.

Many countries are confronting a difficult question: Is it riskier to pass on price increases to a combustible public, accelerating inflation, or bolster subsidies and aid that would drive up public debt and possibly threaten the stability of national currencies?

“How much fiscal capacity does Asia or the developing world have in general to manage this geopolitical crisis?” said Sana Jaffrey, a lecturer at the Australian National University who researches conflict and state-building in Asia. “What happens to global financial markets when that capacity starts to run out?”

“At some point,” she added, “it’s going to become everyone’s problem.”

Here are some global flash

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WEIGHING OPTIONS Gulf Arab states explore alternatives as U.S. bases fail to deter Iran. **PAGE A7**

Doctor A.I. Will See You, in Spite of Misgivings

By **CHRISTINA JEWETT**

The Trump administration is accelerating efforts to make artificial intelligence an integral part of medical care in the United States, throwing the resources and support of the federal government into projects that deploy A.I. agents to diagnose and prescribe treatments to patients.

The multifront effort at the Department of Health and Human Services has raised concerns among some officials over the past few months that change is moving too quickly, with inadequate evidence of the technology’s safety and effectiveness, ac-

U.S. Officials Test Bots That Offer Therapy and Prescriptions

ording to people who have been involved the discussions. They also worry about outsize influence of Silicon Valley investors who have previously played little role in federal health policy.

Vinod Khosla, a billionaire Silicon Valley venture capitalist whose son has a health care A.I. company, has been particularly influential in conversations with

top health department officials, according to people close to the matter. Those officials include Dr. Mehmet Oz, the head of Medicare and Medicaid. Chris Klomp, who faces a confirmation hearing this week to be the second-in-command at the health department, said on a podcast in May that the use of A.I. in patient care was the “holy grail” in the agency’s quest to improve the nation’s health and reduce costs.

Mr. Khosla has predicted for more than a decade that A.I. would largely replace doctors. “It’s over for doctors, human doctors,” he said at a July A.I. start-up

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Ally of Kremlin Feted Trump Jr. And Footed Bill

By **BEN PROTESS**

A Russian businessman with ties to the Kremlin paid hundreds of thousands of dollars to help finance Donald Trump Jr.’s wedding after-party in the Bahamas this year, according to two people with knowledge of the matter.

The payments represented an extraordinary flouting of ethical norms for an American president’s family.

To avoid foreign influence, a president’s family is generally expected to steer clear of these sorts of personal and pricey gifts, particularly from someone in a country like Russia, an adversary known to surreptitiously push its geopolitical agenda. The concern, ethics experts say, is that a foreign actor could ply a president’s family member with gifts and eventually expect something in return.

Mr. Trump, the president’s eldest son, accepted the gifts from Umar Kremlev, the president of the International Boxing Association, according to the people with knowledge of the matter. The payments, reported earlier by ProPublica, included the cost of rent-

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SIMBARASHE CHIA/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Fashion Is About Balance

New York Fashion Week, which ended on Tuesday, brought anticipated debuts and brand resets. Coverage at [nytimes.com](#).

Key West Acutely Feels the Pain Of Haitians’ Loss of Protection

By **DAVID OVALLE**

KEY WEST, Fla. — The Haitian hotel housekeepers, restaurant cooks and Uber drivers who quietly help power Key West’s tourism economy are disappearing.

Some have been detained by Border Patrol agents since late July, when the Trump administration ended a legal protection that had allowed 330,000 Haitians to live and work in the United States.

Others are retreating from public spaces, afraid to go about their routines on the mile-wide island that’s typically crowded with partying tourists, sunburned fishermen and cruise ship day-trippers. Many Haitians — along with Hispanic immigrants — have stopped riding bicycles to work, a common form of transportation in Key West, for fear of attracting law en-

forcement attention.

It’s a situation familiar to communities across Florida; the state has the nation’s largest Haitian population, including tens of thousands who have lost the legal safeguard known as Temporary Protected Status, which the United States had granted them because of the violence and instability in their home country.

But Key West is unique, a remote sliver of land surrounded by open water, linked to Miami by a single highway running more than 100 miles through the island

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DOCUMENTS Immigrants’ lawyers said the U.S. is redacting records proving legal status. **PAGE A14**

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

U.S. Approves Israel Arms Sale

The proposed \$2.8 billion package includes 40,000 one-ton bombs whose use has drawn condemnation. **PAGE A5**

Family, Fortune and Sex Abuse

An heir to a Thailand beer empire has prompted a rare public reckoning over a topic considered taboo. **PAGE A4**



NATIONAL A11-19

Kennedy Center Closes Doors

The action by the performing arts venue, which cited safety concerns, poses an aggressive test of a federal judge’s order in the escalating battle. **PAGE A12**

A \$1 Million Math Problem

A New York University mathematician was on the path toward an important proof when an A.I. giant used its vast resources to get there first. **PAGE A16**

Anxiety Over Los Angeles Run

When a Latino running club tried to host an event in the cultural heart of the city’s Black community, a social media firestorm broke out. **PAGE A11**

BUSINESS B1-6

Why Things Cost So Much

Before the pandemic, steak was \$8 a pound. Now it’s \$13, as the effect of fast-rising inflation has kept accumulating over the years. **PAGE B1**

Fed Chief at a Crossroads

The central bank is expected to raise rates, putting Kevin M. Warsh at odds with the president’s wishes. **PAGE B1**

SPORTS B7-10

Diamond Dream Come True

A women’s baseball league is striving to become a fixture of the game after a successful inaugural season. **PAGE B7**

ARTS C1-6

Pitch Perfect, With Help

As audiences demand perfection from live performances, more singers are relying on Auto-Tune to deliver. **PAGE C1**

Best and Worst of Emmys

We found a lot to like, and not like, at the show. Below, a golden Meg Stalter and Paul W. Downs of “Hacks.” **PAGE C1**



FOOD D1-8

Making the Best of Mistakes

In a new memoir, Danny Meyer, the man behind Shake Shack, finds a positive side to his worst blunders. **PAGE D8**

Heaven-Sent Pastry

Sixteenth-century nuns came up with the recipe, and a Portuguese village is still dedicated to perfecting it. **PAGE D7**

OPINION A22-23

Bret Stephens

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